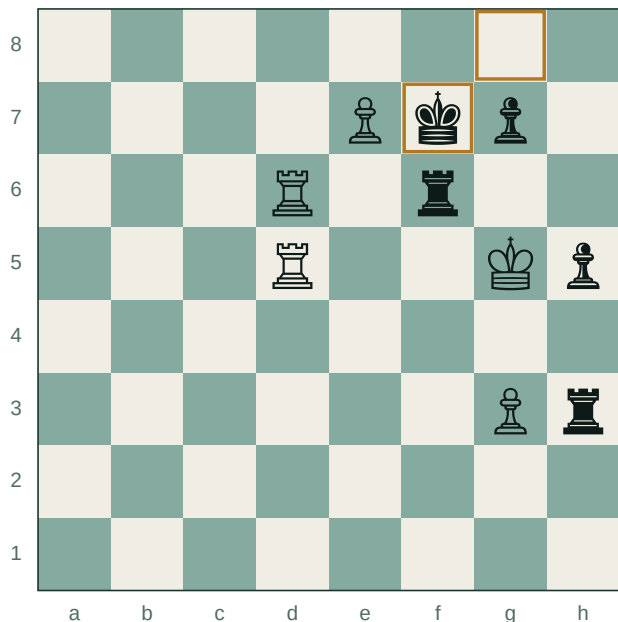


# Quiet tactical moves: White, move 40

Quiet tactical moves

White to move



Previous move: 39...Kf7. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

**WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST**

**40. Re5 Rxc3+ 41. Kh4 Rg4+ 42. Kxh5 Rf5+ 43. Rxf5+**

**40.Re5** The rook moves from d5 to e5. Recorded reply: **40...Rxc3+**.

**41.Kh4** The king moves from g5 to h4. Recorded reply: **41...Rg4+**.

**42.Kxh5** The king captures the pawn on h5. Recorded reply: **42...Rf5+**.

**43.Rxf5+** Check restricts Black to 3 legal replies here. The move also takes the rook on f5.

At the end, nominal material is White 11 / Black 6 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +5. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

## CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +5: the balance goes from +0 to +5. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

## CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Because the move is not forcing by check, the opponent has time for counterplay. Test every serious check and direct threat.

## WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A quiet move can win by threatening something the defender cannot meet, even though it gives no check and makes no capture. It often supplies the missing support in a near-working combination.

## HOW TO LOOK

Use failed forcing lines to identify an escape square or defender. Search for a move that removes that resource while keeping the threat.

The defending king is on f7. Geometrically undefended: rook on h3. Check for tactical protection.